Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

July 2010 Volume 53, Number 7 Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

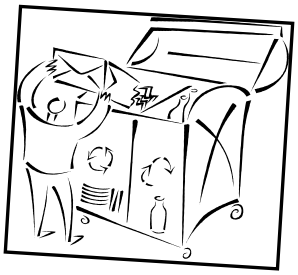
July Monthly Meeting on Dumpster Day

7:00 pm in the Lakewood School Multi-Purpose Room

Dumpster Day is July 17th!

President's Column

-Fred Fowler



Greetings! In just a few days the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association will be staging the 2010 edition of one of our most beloved events, ***Dumpster Day***! At least 19 Dumpsters will be delivered to the neighborhood and will be open for business on Saturday, July 17th.with dozens of volunteers manning them. We'll be devoting our July LVNA general meeting to getting everyone organized and prepared. **Come to the Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, July 14th** to get the low-down on where the dumpsters will be placed, what will be allowed to be put in them and how long they will stay.

LVNA 2nd Vice President Skip Gottschalk has done a wonderful job putting the event together this year. He has coordinated with the City of Sunnyvale to make sure the dumpsters are placed in good locations. He has recruited and/or coordinated a small army of dumpster monitors to watch over them and make sure they are not abused. He has also arranged for City of Sunnyvale Neighborhood Preservation Specialist Johanne Navarro-Tran and (hopefully) a Neighborhood Resource Officer to come speak to us on July 14th. Johanne and the NRO will go over the rules for what is allowed in the dumpsters this year and what must be kept out! The NRO will also give some tips and advice as to how to handle any "tense" situations, such as when someone who wants to dump something illegal is told "No".

The LVNA will be providing sandwiches on the 17th to any volunteer who wants one. There will be a sign-up sheet for the sandwiches at the July 14th meeting. If you want a sandwich, please come to the meeting and sign up! (We are getting a special deal from Togo's on Lawrence Expressway and have to get them a firm list ahead of time.)

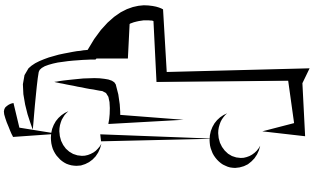
The LVNA Dumpster Day is the oldest and most successful neighborhood clean-up event in Sunnyvale. This year will mark its 20th anniversary! In those 20 years, because of ***Dumpster Days***, we've removed a little more than 4,000 tons of junk, trash and other refuse from our houses, garages and back yards. Let's keep up the good work! Come to the LVNA meeting on July 14th and get informed. I'll see you there! ◆

◆

➔ ***Please note: Anyone who has volunteered to watch a dumpster is <u>strongly</u> encouraged to attend the July 14th LVNA meeting. Also, anyone who will be participating in any capacity is asked to attend as well. Dumpster monitors must attend the meeting in order to pick up their "packets" of signs, dumpster maps, handouts and other materials.*** ➔

Dumpster Day Drivers Needed!

By Fred Fowler



Calling all pickup truck and/or utility van owners! The LVNA is looking for some volunteers with vehicles who can collect discarded Dumpster Day items in good condition and take them to our "**garage sale**" site in the Lakewood Shopping Center.

Every ***Dumpster Day*** there are new or nearly-new items that are rescued from their trip to the landfill and set aside to be sold. I personally have seen brand new bicycles, exercise equipment, golf clubs, usable power tools, functional personal computers and even a $200 women's leather jacket pulled from the dumpster. As these things accumulate they need to be collected and delivered to the volunteers near the Shell station where they are offered for sale. In years past, the LVNA has made hundreds of dollars from the proceeds of these sales.

This year we need some help collecting and delivering these goods. Two key volunteers who have done this work in the past are not available this time. We need some fresh faces to step up.

If you are interested, please contact **Dumpster Day Coordinator Skip Gottschalk** at the following e-mail address: gottschalk.ralph@ssd.loral.com.

If you prefer, you can call my cell phone at (408) 505-2813. **Please respond! The neighborhood needs you.** Thanks in advance for making this contribution to Dumpster Day. ◆

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Newsletter Distribution Coordinator Needed

By Fred Fowler

The LVNA has a tradition of hand-delivering *The LVNA Villager* newsletter. Each month a crew of almost 30 volunteers distribute copies of it door to door in every part of our neighborhood. We reach 1,600 homes with a 6 page document that often contains news about the neighborhood that is simply not available from any other source. The overall distribution of *The LVNA Villager* is coordinated by two volunteers, one for each side of the neighborhood. We'll soon need a new coordinator for the Fairwood side, as the current volunteer has been doing it for a long time.

We distribute *The LVNA Villager* by hand for two reasons. First, it would cost close to $800 per month in postage alone to send the newsletter out by mail. Second, it gives us a way to disseminate information in an emergency. If the "Big One" ever hits Lakewood Village, our network of newsletter walkers will be very important for surveying and reporting damage, as well as passing out emergency relief information. That network of walkers is important for our safety as well as for handing out the newsletter each month.

The Lakewood and Fairwood sides of the neighborhood each have a coordinator to support the walkers. The newsletter editor picks up the finished newsletters from the printer and splits them between the Lakewood and Fairwood coordinators. The Lakewood coordinator is Wendy Stanley. She takes 800 copies of *The LVNA Villager* and passes them out to the walkers on the Lakewood side. The Fairwood coordinator is Bev Woidyla. She passes out her 800 copies to the walkers on the Fairwood side.

Both Bev and Wendy have done a great job of coordinating their walkers for a long time. Bev has been doing it for four years now, and she has given notice that she would like us to find someone to take over for her. She will continue to coordinate Fairwood distribution for the July and August editions of *The LVNA Village*, but we need someone else to handle the chore starting with the September issue.

Phyllis and I coordinated the Fairwood side walkers back in the 1990s, and the workload wasn't too heavy. Once per month we received a stack of 800 newsletters, and we had a list of walkers and the streets they covered. Our job was to count out the number of newsletters each walker needed, and to drive around Fairwood delivering the newsletter stacks to those volunteers. It took about 2 –3 hours on a Saturday morning, once per month.

Does someone out there have 2 - 3 hours once per month that you can spare? The job isn't very complicated, but it is very important. Without you, we may not be able to keep at least 800 households informed as to what is happening in the Village.

Please e-mail me (fred@fmfa.com) or call me at (408) 505-2813. By the way, the job will not be a *thankless* job. Last March, Bev Woidyla received certificates of commendation from Mayor Melinda Hamilton, Assembly member Paul Fong and Congresswoman Anna Eshoo, all thanking her for her work on behalf of Lakewood Village. If you agree to take this on and do a good job with it, I'll do my darnedest to make sure *your name* is nominated for those certificates next time! It shouldn't be too hard, those publice officials like and respect the LVNA and love to express the public's gratitude for the LVNA volunteers' work.

What are yo waiting for? Why don't you "throw your hat in the ring?" Please e-mail me (fred@fmfa.com) or call me at (408) 505-2813. I'm looking forward to hearing from you soon! ◆

Just around the corner: The LVNA Picnic!

By Fred Fowler

Hello neighbors. It is July, and the year is flying by! It wasn't long ago that our elections were held and the 2010 Association year got started. We're now less than two weeks away from holding our 20th annual *Dumpster Day* event! What's more, it isn't too early to start working on the other big events we stage every year. The next big push will be for our neighborhood picnic, scheduled for ***Lakewood Park picnic area on September 25th***. Lakewood Village needs an energetic and selfless individual to step forward and take charge of the planning and organization of the event.

PICNIC PREPARATIONS

The annual summer picnic has been an LVNA tradition for more than 20 years. Sometime in late summer or early fall, the picnic area is reserved and food is prepared for whoever wishes to come and share it. In the past we've had a DJ with music, a piñata for the kids, raffles, door prizes, and lots and lots of food. We've generally gone out to local businesses and asked for food donations. We've also asked neighbors to bring their own dishes to the party, pot luck style. The last time I was president of the LVNA (1997) we ended up feeding 300+ people with nothing but donated food. It was a great way to come together as neighbors and celebrate life in our nice little corner of Sunnyvale.

Just like every other big, complicated event we do, the annual picnic needs a ***Coordinator*** to make sure it comes off smoothly. Someone has to make sure that all of the various "ducks" get in line properly so that when people show up, there is actually some food for them to eat! Someone has to be thinking about all of the details, such as who will do the cooking, how the donated food will be stored and how the picnic area will be cleaned up after the event is over.

Organizing the picnic falls into two phases. The *first phase, preparation*, involves asking volunteers to sign up for tasks and asking businesses for contributions. *(Cont. page 5)*

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LVNA Clean up Event

July 17, 2010 - Saturday

The City of Sunnyvale is sponsoring the yearly clean-up event which promotes keeping the neighborhood clean and safe. **The dumpsters will not be available for use until the BIN MONITORS open the bins at 8:00 a.m. on Saturday. The dumpsters will be picked up at 2:00 p.m.**

DUMPSTER DO'S AND DONT'S

DO: **Distribute items in dumpster evenly.**
DO: **Place furniture into dumpster. Use another bin if the first one is full.**
DON'T: **Overfill the dumpsters. They can not be serviced if overfilled.**
DON'T: **Dump auto parts/ refrigerators / air conditioners/construction debris/ business waste.**
DON'T: **Dispose of syringes in bins. Place them into an approved sharps container and drop off at the SMaRT Station, 301 Carl Rd. at no additional cost.**
DON'T: **Put paint, motor oil, or other household hazardous waste into Dumpster. For information about Household Hazardous Waste, please call (408) 730-7262.**
DON'T: **Dispose of electronic devices, small appliances, televisions or computer monitors, fluorescent lights, or mercury thermometers. These items may be recycled at SMaRT Station seven days a week by Sunnyvale residents at no cost. For information, please call (408) 730-7262.**

HOUSEHOLD HAZARDOUS WASTE

Household hazardous waste drop off days are on the 3rd Saturday of each month from 8 am to 1 pm (except December) at 164 Carl Road, just west of the SMaRT Station. **NEXT EVENT: July 17**

Latex & Oil based paints and stains	* Batteries	*Mercury, Thermometers	Fire Extinguishers
* Motor Oil	* Automotive Fluids	Adhesives	Flammable or Combustible liquids
* Oil Filters	Insecticides	Pool Chemicals	Household & Automotive cleaners
* Antifreeze	Herbicides	Aerosol cans	Compressed gas Cylinders

*** Residents can also recycle these at the SMaRT Station at 301 Carl Rd., Sunnyvale, 7 days, 8:00a.m. to 5:00p.m.**

Placing these products in the garbage may cause harm to collection personnel and pollute the environment when sent to the landfill. Residents may bring these items to the monthly drop off events at no charge. For more information on proper disposal/recycling of materials contact the City of Sunnyvale Recycling at (408) 730-7262 or go to www.sunnyvalerecycles.org. If you have any questions please call Jhoanne Navarro-Tran, Neighborhood Preservation Specialist at (408) 730-7447.

Thank you for Participating in the City of Sunnyvale LVNA Clean-up Event
FOR ILLEGAL DUMPING, PLEASE CALL SUNNYVALE PUBLIC SAFETY AT (408) 730-7180

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((Picnic continued from page 2)

The *second phase on picnic day*, involves making sure that everything is in the right place and everyone is doing what they are supposed to. Besides food, we'll need charcoal, plates, cups, ice, drinks, plastic forks, etc. We'll need people to cook the hamburgers and hot dogs, set up tables, give out raffle tickets, etc. There are lots of details to keep track If all this sounds daunting, let me tell you about the help you'll have. First of all, the neighborhood has staged the picnic many times before, so there is a large pool of experienced people who can help. Finding cooks, ticket takers, setup and cleanup people and all the other picnic day volunteers should be no problem. As for preparation help, I will be happy to do the lion's share of soliciting donations from local businesses. I actually enjoy telling local companies about Lakewood Village and asking for their help. So don't let that stop you from volunteering to handle the other tasks. I'll be happy to get the donated food and supplies if you will handle the rest.

WHY IT'S IMPORTANT

How important is the picnic to the neighborhood? Let me tell you the story of the picnic we had in the year 2000. Back then I was on the
(cont.)

(cont.)

Sunnyvale City Council, and I invited State **Assembly Member Mike Honda** to enjoy the picnic with us. (Mike was running for the Congressional district that contained Lakewood Village at the time.) Mike came to the picnic and had a ball! He danced the "YMCA" with the kids, talked with many of the "old timers" in the neighborhood and was very impressed with the sense of community he found here. A few weeks later **Vice President Al Gore** contacted Mike and said he would like to make a campaign stop in Silicon Valley to help both Mike's and his own election campaign. Mike Honda told Al Gore in no uncertain terms that the campaign event had to be held in Lakewood Village! And so it came about that on September 20th, 2000, the Vice President of the United States paid a visit to Lakewood Park. It is important to note that he did not wish to visit just *Sunnyvale*. The Sunnyvale Public Safety department tried and failed to get the venue switched to the Baylands Park, which would have been easier to manage from a security point of view. The Gore campaign insisted that the event be held in Lakewood Park because of what Mike Honda had told them about the LVNA picnic.

I'm not suggesting that I expect the upcoming picnic to be so successful that it draws a visit from Barak Obama. I'm just saying that the picnic is very important and can have beneficial side effects that are both wonderful and unpredictable. We need to keep this neighborhood tradition going and build upon our previous success. In order to do so, we need a selfless volunteer to join the long line of other selfless volunteers who have made a personal commitment to bringing the LVNA picnic about one more time.

I know you are out there, and I know you are reading this. Pick up the phone and give me a call! After Dumpster Day we will have only two LVNA meetings before the picnic takes place. It is time to get started! Call me a (408) 505-2813, or e-mail me at fred@fmfa.com. Do it today. And thank you, on behalf of all your neighbors in Lakewood Village. ◆

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Important Phone Numbers

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Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Complaints about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses or rental housing	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010

LVNA Contacts:

President **- Fred Fowler** **(408) 747-1454**
Advertising **- Terry Lin** **(408) 747-1638**
Newsletter Delivery:
Fairwood - Bev Woidyla **(408)736-6225**
Lakewood - Wendy Stanley **(408) 745-1331**

Upcoming Events

Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	**8/3 Fairwood** **8/10 Lakewood**
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	near SMaRT Station	**8/21 8 am - 1 pm**

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To contact the editor, Please call Phyllis Fowler at (408)747-1454 or email editor@lvna.net
Or Mail to: 921 Lakebird Dr, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
Editorial Deadline for submissions for the August Newsletter: by July 30th

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